on the information received, which may be converted into a cognition that is raised to the level of explicit awareness. A cognition occurs in the principle of identity (***atman***). Whether the information becomes conscious awareness is determined by what is relevant to the present state of the complex of experiences that is unified by being related to the one identity. This account of perceptual process explains why I can say that I am touching and tasting what I also see. Although each sense is correlated with its proper objects, the ***manas*** synthesises the information received.

The dominant Buddhist outlook is that each sense-faculty is exclusively correlated with its proper objects, each sense-object contact producing a different type of awareness. So when the eye, for example, is related to colours and shapes, a visual sensation occurs and it produces a visual awareness. But they have a problem in that they admit neither a persisting mind nor a persisting subject of experience. Instead, different sensory impressions naturally cooperate to produce a complex sensation in a stream of experiences.

Further reading: G. Bhattacharya 1989; Chakrabarti 1999; Larson and Bhattacharya 1987; Potter 1977; Stcherbatsky 1993

Ishvara, proving the existence of God: given assumptions that the existence of the world is not self-explanatory and that its organisation cannot be accounted for by unconscious factors like ***karma***, some ***Nyaya*** thinkers try to prove inferentially the existence of the unperceived God by considering aspects of the world which imply a creator capable of planning.

Vacaspati Mishra (850 or 976 CE) argues that we know that some objects have makers, while realities such as the atmosphere do not. But we do not know whether many natural phenomena such as mountains, oceans and the